

The Secret of Education

How to Awaken Human Potential?



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*In the Name of Allah,
the All-beneficent,
the All-merciful.*

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Dedication

Peace be upon you,
O Messenger of Allah
Peace be upon you,
O Imam Jafar Sadiq
Peace be upon you,
O Imam Mahdi

I dedicate this writing to the Messenger of God (peace be upon him and his progeny), Imam Ja'far al-Sadiq, and the Imam of our time. I pray to Almighty God that He blesses us with the gnosis (Ma'rifat) of all these personalities and grants all of us the ability to benefit from the true gnosis and awareness of the Qur'an and Ahlul Bayt!

O Imam of our time, help us!

Introduction

Dear Readers, the effect of centuries of colonial slavery is that even today, especially in the subcontinent, most people consider the Western education system to be the guarantee of success! We Muslims have lost our precious scholarly values from our own hands in such a way that even today, we have not realized what game has been played with us.

Come, let us embark on a scholarly journey together that will give our thinking a new direction and help us understand the true meaning of education. This is an

understanding that is much deeper and more powerful than the language of borders and statistics. The only important thing is that we must reflect and ponder.

Have you ever thought that despite all our efforts, our children are unable to make full use of their true potential? Why do some students understand everything easily while others are left behind? Today, we will review a modern research study in the field of education called the "2 Sigma Problem." After that, we will take guidance from the timeless ocean of wisdom, that is, Nahjul Balagha, so that it can also be proven that God

Almighty has already informed us, through the Ahlul Bayt, about all the ways to awaken the hidden potential of humanity; the shortcoming is only from our side.

Part One: What is Sigma?

A simple way to measure performance.

Imagine you are watching a cricketer's performance. He sometimes scores a lot of runs and sometimes very few. But overall, he has an average score.

What is Sigma (σ)?

In simple words, think of "sigma" as a measure of consistency in your performance.

Small Sigma: If a cricketer scores runs around his average score in almost every match (for example, between 40 and 60), his "sigma"

will be small. This means his performance is reliable.

Large Sigma: If his scores are very different—sometimes 150 and sometimes only 5—his "sigma" will be large. This means there is a lot of fluctuation in his performance.

Another example:

If all the arrows of an expert archer land right in the center of the target, his sigma is small. His aim is accurate and consistent. If a new learner shoots an arrow and his arrows are scattered all over the target, his sigma is large. His aim is inconsistent.

When scientists talk about "two sigma" (2 Sigma), it means that a result is very significant and reliable.

Part Two: "The 2 Sigma Problem"

A surprising discovery in the world of education.

In the year 1984, an education expert named Benjamin Bloom conducted a research study that raised questions about the old methods of education.

What did Bloom discover?

He discovered that if an average student is given individual attention through special methods, his performance becomes twice as good. In the language of science, this is called a two-sigma (2 Sigma) improvement.

Point: The interesting thing is that this system of individual attention was historically prevalent in Muslim societies. In Arabia, Persia, or the subcontinent, education was imparted in the same way, meaning a child would first receive education from a single scholar, teacher, or parent for several years, and upon reaching maturity, he would become so proficient that he had to strive and search for his own teacher, like the examples of Avicenna (Bu Ali Sina) and many other scholars like him before us. This same method has been prevalent in the Hawza Ilmiyya (Islamic seminaries) until now,

where the effects of Western education have also begun to appear.

What does this mean for our children?

It means that an average student, who normally comes in at the 50th position in class (meaning half the children are ahead of him and half are behind), can reach the 98th position with this special guidance! Meaning he can perform better than 98 out of 100 children.

This proved that almost every child has the potential to become the best; they just need the right guidance.

What was this special method for success?

This extraordinary result was not achieved through ordinary teaching alone; rather, it was a combination of several effective methods:

- **Individual Attention:** The full attention of one teacher was on only one student.
- **Education until Complete Mastery:** As long as a student did not fully understand a lesson (for example, did not score 90% on a test), he was not moved forward. In case of weakness, he was given additional help.

- **Continuous Assessment and Correction:** The student was given frequent small tests so that he could correct his mistakes immediately.
- **Trained Teacher:** The teacher not only knew the subject matter but also possessed the skill of teaching, encouraging, and providing proper guidance.
- **A Complete System:** This special method of education was an alternative to regular classroom teaching, not an extra add-on.

Bloom named it the "2 Sigma Problem" because he challenged the world to find ways through

which the entire class could also be taught with the same standard of education. Today, some institutions are also trying to solve this problem with the help of AI. If this technology is used correctly, it is possible that this important human problem can be solved.

Part Three: Nahjul Balagha

An ancient and complete plan for an excellent life.

Now, dear ones, let's move away from modern research and turn towards the treasure of wisdom that we have in the form of Nahjul Balagha. Although Imam Ali (peace be upon him) did not use words like "sigma," his teachings present a complete code for living an excellent and successful life, which we can consider even better than "two sigma," but action is the condition.

1. The Greatness of Knowledge: The Greatest Wealth

To become an excellent student, it is first necessary to understand the value of knowledge. Nahjul Balagha tells us why knowledge is the most valuable thing.

Wisdom of Nahjul Balagha (Saying 147): Imam Ali (peace be upon him) said: "Knowledge is better than wealth. Knowledge protects you, while you have to protect wealth. Wealth decreases by spending, but knowledge increases by spending."

Lesson for Us: We should not see education merely as a means to

get a job or earn money, but as a treasure that protects us and improves our personality.

2. The Diligent Gardener: Excellent Upbringing and Care

Achieving the best results requires guidance filled with hard work and love. The advice that Imam Ali (peace be upon him) gave to his son, Imam Hassan (peace be upon him), is the best example of this.

Wisdom of Nahjul Balagha (Letter 31): He (PBUH) said: "I have chosen for you the best part of everything, just as a loving father does for his child, and I have liked for you those things which are beneficial and have kept useless things away from you."

Lesson for Us: It is the duty of every parent and teacher to provide children with the best and most beneficial knowledge and to protect them from useless things, and to do all this with deep love and care.

3. A Different Method for Each Person: Guidance by Understanding Hearts

Modern research shows that individual attention should be given to every child. Imam Ali (peace be upon him) taught this very principle for guiding the heart and soul centuries ago.

Wisdom of Nahjul Balagha (from Saying 193): He (PBUH) said: "If the heart is forced, it becomes blind."

Lesson for Us: The same method of teaching cannot be applied to everyone. We must understand the temperament and condition of every learner. Forcing education

can create hatred for knowledge in
a child's heart.

4. The Power of Patience: The Secret to Attaining Mastery

To become an expert in any task, one has to face difficulties and not lose courage. This is called patience, which has been described as the key to success in Nahjul Balagha.

Wisdom of Nahjul Balagha (Saying 82): Imam Ali (peace be upon him) said: "The relation of patience to faith is like that of the head to the body. If the head is severed, the body is useless; similarly, if patience is lost, faith is also ruined."

Lesson for Us: We should teach our children that facing difficulty in learning is not a failure. Persisting in the effort with patience is the guarantee of success.

5. Reviewing Oneself: The Best Path to Rectification

In the "two-sigma" method, correction is made through repeated testing. This is the same thing that Islam teaches us in the form of "reviewing oneself."

Wisdom of Nahjul Balagha (Saying 208): Imam Ali (peace be upon him) said: "Whoever took account of himself, succeeded."

Lesson for Us: We should instill in children the habit of recognizing and correcting their own mistakes. Examinations should not be seen as a symbol of fear, but should be considered a "mirror" in which we

see an opportunity to improve
ourselves.

6. Teaching Through Action: More Effective Than Words

The role of a good teacher is very important. Nahjul Balagha tells us that the greatest teacher is a person's own actions and character.

Wisdom of Nahjul Balagha (Saying 73): He said: "He who places himself as a leader of the people should begin by teaching himself before teaching others, and his teaching should be by his conduct before it is by his tongue."

Lesson for Us: Our actions are more powerful than our words. If we want our children to be truthful

and virtuous, we must first become
a model of these qualities
ourselves.

7. A Good Environment: Fertile Ground for Growth

Just as a plant needs good soil, a child needs a good environment. Even the best education can be wasted in a bad environment.

Wisdom of Nahjul Balagha (Saying 303): Imam Ali (peace be upon him) warned: "Avoid the friendship of a fool, for he presents his wrongdoings to you as something good and desires that you too become like him."

Lesson for Us: Our duty is not limited to school. We must help our children in making good friends and create an environment at home and in society where

knowledge and good morals are
valued.

8. The Danger of Ignorance: True Poverty

To understand the light of knowledge, it is necessary to recognize the darkness of ignorance. Nahjul Balagha makes it clear that the real poverty is ignorance.

Wisdom of Nahjul Balagha (Saying 54): Imam Ali (peace be upon him) said: "There is no wealth like wisdom, and no poverty like ignorance."

Lesson for Us: The greatest poverty we should fear for our society is not a lack of money, but a lack of knowledge and understanding.

Conclusion: The Real Step to Success

Dear readers, certainly learn from the educational systems of the world, but do not be so impressed by them that you forget the treasures of wisdom that you possess.

The "2 Sigma Problem," in the language of modern science, is a testimony to an ancient truth: that if the right method is adopted—one that is tailored to each individual's needs, teaches complete mastery, and is based on patience—then every person can achieve extraordinary success.

Nahjul Balagha shows us the path to this very success. It teaches us to become diligent gardeners of the human soul, to teach through our actions, and to prioritize knowledge over all wealth.

Let us not be content with an ordinary life for ourselves and our children. Let us, by acting on these timeless teachings of Nahjul Balagha, take that "two-sigma" level and even better, standard, strong, and firm step forward—not just in studies, but in character, in faith, and on the path of closeness to God. Because this is the true measure of success.